FAMILY AND SOCIETY IN ISLAM

FACULTY OF ISLAMIC STUDIES

GENERAL EDUCATION

DIHPE - DOW UNIVERSITY OF HEALTH SCIENCES (DUHS)

LECTURE# 5

PART (III)

FAMILY STRUCTURE

AND

VALUES IN MUSLIM SOCIETY

EXTENDED & NUCLEAR FAMILY SYSTEMS

Human family systems are normally divided into two types:



Extended (or Joint) Family System



Nuclear (or Separate) Family System

EXTENDED & NUCLEAR FAMILY SYSTEMS

EXTENDED FAMILY SYSTEM

- In this system, all members of a family, including father, son, brother, sister, uncle, nephew, and others, live together.
- The income of everyone is considered collective property, and the expenses of all members are met from this collective income.
- This system promotes togetherness, mutual trust, and cooperation among family members.
- However, it can also lead to laziness and dependency among some family members and may reduce the incentive to work harder among others.
- This system is prevalent in Hindu society.

NUCLEAR FAMILY SYSTEM

- In the Nuclear Family System, each person is responsible for their immediate dependents only.
- This means that individuals are accountable for their own family's well-being and support. Unlike in an extended family, where income and resources are often shared among relatives, in a nuclear family, each person's income is considered their own, not belonging to the entire family.
- While this system offers advantages such as increased privacy and autonomy, it can also lead to self-centeredness and selfishness, as the focus is primarily on the nuclear family unit rather than the broader family network.

OUTER FAMILY CIRCLE

- Distant relatives with moral and social rights. Islam promotes keeping ties with them (Silat-ur-Rahm).

This structure strengthens kinship and creates a strong support network within society.

THE ISLAMIC VIEW

Islam combines the benefits of both extended and nuclear family systems while avoiding their disadvantages. It endorses the Nuclear Family System by clearly defining dependents, such as one's wife, parents, and children, for whom one must provide. Simultaneously, Islam emphasizes strong kinship bonds (silatu 'r-rahm), encouraging assistance to relatives.

Family Forms in Islam:

- A couple and their children.
- A couple, their parents, and their children.

Imam Ja`far as-Sadiq (RA) stated that, “The ways of spending one's wealth are twenty-four in all...Thus, the five ways in which spending wealth is obligatory (wajib) are the expenses of the maintenance of one's children, father, mother, wife and slave. These expenses are obligatory upon him whether he is financially in constrain or affluent.”

Verse 61 of Surah Al-Noor supports both aspects:

Self-reliance and Self-support:

The verse mentions eating in the houses of close family members, implying separate households for each, which suggests self-reliance and self-support.

Unity and Friendship:

The verse also promotes unity and friendship by allowing people to eat at the houses of their extended family members without prior permission and greeting them with a blessed greeting.

VERSE 61 OF SURAH AN-NUR

"There is no harm for the blind and there is no harm for the lame and there is no restriction on the sick nor on any one of you, that you eat in the houses of your children or the houses of your fathers, or the houses of your mothers or the houses of your brothers, or the houses of your sisters or the houses of your uncles or the houses of your paternal aunts, or the houses of your maternal uncles, or the houses of your maternal aunts, or from those places of which the keys are in your possession or from the house of your friend. There is no blame upon you whether you eat together or separately. Then when you enter any house, salute your own people, a nice greeting from Allah at the time of meeting, blessed, pure. Thus, Allah narrates to you His signs that you may understand."

Islam thus balances individual responsibility with communal support, integrating the advantages of both family systems.

WHAT ARE VALUES?

1. Principles and standards that are considered by people as important.
2. Values specify the bad and the good for individuals and societies.
3. Morals, norms, manners, ethics & Akhlaq are alternative terms.

VALUES IN ISLAM

- Values are at the heart of Islamic faith.
- Prophet Mohammed PBUH said: “Indeed, I have only been sent to perfect the noble Qualities of morals”.(Ahmed)
- Values are based on the belief in Allah and the last day.
- Abu Hurairah reported: The Prophet PBUH said: “He who believe in Allah and the last day, let him show hospitality to his guest; and he who believe in Allah and the last day, let him maintain good relationship with kins; and he who believe in Allah and the last day, let him speak good or remain silent.” (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

Values spread through the good example

Allah SWT says:

"There has been for you in the Messenger of Allah an excellent pattern (an example to be followed) for anyone whose hope is in Allah and the last day and who remembers Allah often."
(Surat Al-Ahzab 33:21)

EXPECTED REWARD

Abu Umamah Al-Bahili reported: Messenger of Allah ﷺ said,

“I guarantee a house in Jannah for one who gives up arguing, even if he is in the right; and I guarantee a home in the middle of Jannah for one who abandons lying even for the sake of fun; and I guarantee a house in the highest part of Jannah for one who has good manners.” (Abu Dawud).

HONESTY / TRUTHFULNESS

Prophet Muhammad (peace and blessings be upon him), said:

"I order you to be truthful, A true action leads to the path of virtue and good deeds, and virtue paves the way of a person to Paradise, and the said person continues to speak the truth till in the sight of Allah he is named Siddiq (Truthful). Lying leads to vice, and vice leads to indecent acts, and a person goes on lying till in the sight of Allah he is named a liar." (Al-Bukhari and Muslim)

TRUSTWORTHINESS

The Messenger of Allah (SAW) was the embodiment of trustworthiness. The Makkans called him ‘the Trustworthy One.’

Even after the declaration of his Prophethood, they continued to entrust their precious goods to him although they regarded him as an enemy.

He warned his people against lying, breaking one’s word and breach of trust.

> “Like breaching a trust and breaking one’s word, lying was also, in his words, ‘a sign of hypocrisy’.” (Abu Dawud, Adab, 80; I. Hanbal, 3.447)

CARE

Allah SWT stated in Surah Al-Nisa verse 36:

> “Worship Allah and associate nothing with Him, and to parents do good, and to relatives, orphans, the needy, the near neighbor, the neighbor farther away, the companion at your side, the traveler, and those whom your right hands possess. Indeed, Allah does not like those who are self-deluding and boastful.”

It includes all creatures.

Prophet PBUH said:

“If a Muslim plants a tree or grows grains and a bird, a person or an animal eats from it will be counted as a charity for him.”

(Al-Bukhari)

MERCY AND RESPECT

Amr ibn Shu'ayb reported from his grandfather that the Messenger of Allah, may Allah bless him and grant him peace, said,

“Anyone who does not show mercy to our children nor acknowledge the right of our old people is not one of us.”

(Al-Adab Al- Mufrad)

EQUALITY

- Allah SWT says:

"O mankind, indeed, We have created you from male and female and made you peoples and tribes that you may know one another. Indeed, the most noble of you in the sight of Allah is the most righteous of you. Indeed, Allah is Knowing and Aware." (Surat Al-Hujrat 49:13)

- It is a fact that every Muslim helps the other Muslim, his neighbor friend, or even a Muslim country. All Muslims are brethren of each other even if they are from different families, races, and countries, or have different skin color and language.

- The brotherhood of Muslims is a very deep and wide concept that guarantees the safety and well being of the Society at large.
- Islam being a complete way of life is primarily for the society; it promotes a healthy and a well-disciplined lifestyle in every sense of the word. For example, it is forbidden for two Muslims to start a whispering conversation in the presence of the third person.
- This might offend the one left out and weaken the Brotherhood.
- It is not permissible for a Muslim to break relations with his brother for more than three days.
  - "None of you will have faith until he wishes for his brother what he likes for himself." (Sahih Muslim)

PEACE

Abu Huraira reported: The Messenger of Allah, (SAW), said: “The Muslim is the one from whose tongue and hand the people are safe, and the believer is the one people trust with their lives and wealth.”

(Sunan Al-Nasa’i)

PATIENCE

"Allah surely loves those who are the Sabireen (patient)."

(3:146)

Everything Allah chooses for you; from good or evil, is for your benefit. Whatever occurred to you could not have missed you and what missed you could never have reached you. Rewards are only for those who are patient with the Decree of Allah.

Being patient is a great virtue and comes with a great reward.

PATIENCE IS OF THREE TYPES:

1. Patience upon obedience, To be patient when finding it hard obeying Allah's rules.
2. To be patient when a trouble befalls you.
3. To be patient when finding it hard to abstain from sins.

- Muslim values are drawn from the Sharia (Islamic law) and Islam's teaching on ethics, morality, family, rights, social relations, and commerce.
- The five basic values of the Sharia are protection of life, protection of religion, protection of intellect, advocating family values, and responsible accumulation of wealth and property.

FINALLY

- Islamic values are doable.
- We need to practice our values all the time and everywhere.
- Respectful to teachers and classmates.
- Looking after school property.
- Standing before our Creator (in prayer) the most appropriate way.
- Considering study as an act of worship.
- Respectful to parents.
- Good role models to younger siblings.
- Clean and tidy.
- Good neighbors
- In the wider community: Good ambassadors of Islam

CONCLUSION

- Islam provides a deeply rooted, divinely guided, and practical model for family life.
- It promotes justice, compassion, mutual rights, and obligations.
- Women are given high status as daughters, wives, and mothers, while men are tasked with protection and provision.
- Marriage is encouraged as a stable and honorable bond, not merely for physical union but for emotional and spiritual growth.
- Gender roles are defined with flexibility and wisdom, ensuring that each member contributes to a peaceful home and society.
- Islamic teachings and the life of Prophet Muhammad (SAW) offer a complete guide for building a balanced family and a moral civilization.
- When practiced with sincerity, the Islamic family system can counter the moral challenges of the modern world and build a society rooted in faith, love, and justice.

THANK YOU